GRADE 8 · TERM 1 · LESSON 3

PERSONAL EFFICACY

Lesson icons

LEARNING OUTCOMES

🔍 💡 🛠️ By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Define personal efficacy.
- Identify something you have taught yourself.
- Connect personal efficacy to money and goals.

📘 KEY VOCABULARY

Term	Definition	isiZulu	Afrikaans
Personal efficacy	Belief in your ability to succeed at tasks	Ukuzethemba	Selfvertroue
Capability	What you are able to do	Amandla	Vermoë
Transferable skill	A skill that works in many situations	Ikhono elisebenza kuzo zonke izimo	Oordraagbare vaardigheid

📘 LERATO'S HANDS

Lerato lives in Makhanda with her grandmother and three cousins.

Money is tight. Her grandmother works as a domestic worker. Some weeks are good. Some weeks, there is just enough for pap and milk.

Lerato wanted something for herself. Not clothes. Not airtime. A skill.

She watched her cousin struggle with her hair every morning. The cousin would cry. The grandmother would sigh. Everyone would be late.

Lerato had an idea.

She asked a neighbour if she could watch while the neighbour braided her daughter's hair. The neighbour said yes. Lerato watched. She watched the hands move. She watched the patterns form. She watched the patience.

Then she went home and practised.

On a doll first. Then on herself. Then on her cousin, who sat still and hoped.

The first braids were crooked. The second were better. By the tenth try, her cousin smiled in the mirror.

Soon, neighbours started asking: "Can Lerato do my daughter's hair?"

They paid. R20. R30. R50.

Lerato did not wait for someone to teach her. She taught herself.

That is personal efficacy.

⬜ THINKING EQUATION

Skill × Use = Value

💭 REFLECT

Pause and Reflect

Lerato taught herself to braid. What have you taught yourself?

—

Maybe:

- How to cook something
- How to fix a bicycle
- How to help a younger sibling with homework
- How to save airtime by using WiFi
- How to make something and sell it

Think for a moment. Write down one thing you have taught yourself:

✍️ ACTIVITY

Activity 5: My "I Can" Statements — With External Validation

Part A: The List

Complete the sentence "I can..." ten times. Do not overthink. Just write.

Mark each statement: ⭐ — Statements you genuinely believe. ❓ — Statements you are unsure about.

Select one symbol, or select it again to leave the statement unmarked.

1. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_0 Saved	⭐ — A statement I genuinely believe
2. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_1 Saved	❓ — A statement I am unsure about
3. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_2 Saved	⭐ — A statement I genuinely believe
4. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_3 Saved	❓ — A statement I am unsure about
5. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_4 Saved	⭐ — A statement I genuinely believe
6. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_5 Saved	❓ — A statement I am unsure about
7. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_6 Saved	⭐ — A statement I genuinely believe
8. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_7 Saved	❓ — A statement I am unsure about
9. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_8 Saved	⭐ — A statement I genuinely believe
10. I can	SYNTHETIC_ABILITY_9 Saved	❓ — A statement I am unsure about

Part B: External Validation

Show your list to ONE other person. Ask them two questions:

1. "Looking at this list, which one have you actually seen me do?"

2. "What is one skill you see in me that is completely missing from this list?"

Write their answers exactly:

▸ PREVIOUS COMBINED RESPONSE

SYNTHETIC_HISTORICAL_COMBINED

This answer was kept from before the question was separated into individual response fields.

Skill they have seen me do: Seen skill

Saved

Skill missing from my list: Missing skill

Saved

What I learned from their answers: —

📂 **Portfolio evidence**

📘 TRANSFERABLE SKILLS

Lerato's skill is braiding hair. But braiding hair is not just braiding hair. It is also:

- Patience (waiting for the pattern to form)
- Attention to detail (noticing when a braid is uneven)
- Teaching (showing others)
- Customer service (listening to what people want)
- Pricing (deciding what to charge)
- Saving (keeping some money, spending some)

These are transferable skills. They work in many situations.

✍️ ACTIVITY

Activity 6: Find Your Transferable Skills

Choose one thing you are good at. Write it here:

I am good at: —

Now list 3–5 skills hidden inside that one thing:

1. This teaches me: —

2. This teaches me: —

3. This teaches me: —

4. This teaches me: —

5. This teaches me: —

Share with a partner. What did they notice that you missed?

—

📂 **Portfolio evidence**

📘 PERSONAL EFFICACY AND MONEY

Here is why this matters for money:

People with strong personal efficacy:

- Try new ways to earn
- Keep going when things are hard
- Believe they can learn about money
- Ask questions without shame
- Recover from mistakes

People with weak personal efficacy:

- Wait for someone else to fix things
- Give up quickly
- Avoid money conversations
- Stay stuck

You already have personal efficacy. You have already taught yourself things. The question is: can you see it? Can you use it with money?

Deepening Insight
TAP TO EXPLORE THE DEEPER IDEA

Key idea: You have been collecting skills your whole life without knowing it. Every time you tried something new, every time you kept going when it was hard, every time you figured something out — you added to your asset base. You are not poor. You are asset-rich. You just have not named what you own.

Here's the tension: an asset no one will pay for is, in the eyes of the market, not an asset at all. The world will not automatically recognize your skills. You must make them visible. The skill you dismiss as "just something I do" might be your goldmine. The skill you are most proud of might be invisible to everyone except you. You must become a translator of your own worth — learning to speak the language of value without losing the language of who you are.

Your Next Step: Look at your external validation from Activity 5, Part B. What skill did the other person see in you that you missed? What skill on your list is most invisible to others? What is ONE way you could make that invisible skill visible this week — not by bragging, but by using it to help someone?

One skill I will make visible this week: —

How I will do it: —

✅ CHECKPOINT

Checkpoint (🛠️ Apply)

1. Look at your "I Can" statements from Activity 5. Choose one starred item you truly believe in.

—

2. What evidence do you have that you can do this? Write the evidence.

—

3. Now, the squeeze: What is the HARDEST situation where you would still trust this capability?

Imagine a time when everything is going wrong — you are tired, stressed, under pressure.

—

4. In that moment, would this "I can" still hold?

—

5. Name the situation.

—

6. Name what you would do.

—

7. Hardest situation:

—

8. What I would do:

—

TRY THIS AT HOME

Behavioral Experiment

This week, you must use ONE skill from your list to help someone WITHOUT being asked and WITHOUT expecting anything in return.

The skill I will use: —

Who I will help: —

What I will do: —

▸ **If the main task is not possible**

Lesson Wrap

What we learned

- Personal efficacy means believing you can learn and succeed at tasks.
- Skills you already use can transfer to other situations.

Why it matters

Naming a skill and finding evidence for it can help you recognise ways to create value.

Coming next

HOW OTHERS SHAPE US

LESSON NOTES

Anything you want to remember

Your responses are captured beside each activity, reflection, table and workbook field. Use this separate space only for extra notes you want to keep about the lesson.